

SUBJECT: English Language

TOPIC: Phrases

SUB TOPIC: Adjective Phrase

ADJECTIVE PHRASE

Definition

An adjective phrase is a group of words that functions as an adjective in a sentence. It describes or modifies a noun or a pronoun by giving more information about its quality, quantity, size, age, colour, origin, or condition.

The main word in an adjective phrase is called the head adjective

Structure of an Adjective Phrase

An adjective phrase may consist of:

1. An adjective alone

The tall girl won the prize.

2. An adjective with modifiers (intensifiers)

She is very intelligent.

3. An adjective with complements

He is proud of his achievements.

4. Multiple adjectives working together

It was a dark, cold night.

Examples of Adjective Phrases in Sentences

Adjective Phrase.	Sentence
very beautiful.	Shewore a very beautiful dress.
full of water	The bottle is full of water.
extremely difficult	Theexam was extremely difficult.
afraid of dogs	The child is afraid of dogs.
rich in minerals	The soil is rich in minerals.

Position of an Adjective Phrase

An adjective phrase can appear in two main positions:

1. Before the noun (Attributive position)

She bought a highly expensive phone.

2. After the noun (Predicative position)

The phone is highly expensive.

Functions of an Adjective Phrase

An adjective phrase functions to:

Describe a noun

Give more details about a pronoun

Make meaning clearer and more specific

Example:

The students eager to learn arrived early.

Difference Between Adjective and Adjective Phrase

Adjective	Adjective Phrase
happy	very happy
strong	extremely strong
angry	angry with him

How to Identify an Adjective Phrase

To identify an adjective phrase:

1. Look for a noun or pronoun in the sentence.
2. Ask "What kind?" "Which one?" or "How many?"
3. The words answering the question form the adjective phrase.

Summary

An adjective phrase modifies a noun or pronoun.

It contains a head adjective and may include modifiers or complements.

It can appear before or after the noun it describes.